INCH-POUND

A-A-20130A
June 3, 1997
SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKEN FILLETS AND NUGGETS, CHUNKED AND FORMED, BREADED OR UNBREADED, PRECOOKED, INDIVIDUALLY FROZEN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers individually frozen, precooked, breaded and unbreaded, chunked and formed chicken fillets and nuggets, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

The frozen, precooked, chunked and formed chicken fillets and nuggets shall conform to the types and styles in the following list, which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order:

Types.
Type I - 3-ounce fillet
Type II - 5-ounce fillet
Type III - 0.5-ounce (1/2 ounce) nugget

Styles.
Style A - Unbreaded, precooked, individually frozen (IF)
Style B - Breaded, precooked, IF

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, ATTN: DPSC-HSL, Philadelphia, PA 19145-5099 or FAX (215) 737-2963.

AMSC N/A **FSC 8905**

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Basic requirements: The chicken fillets and nuggets shall have been produced and processed from broiler/fryer chickens which have been produced, raised, and processed in the United States, its territories and possessions, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, or the Trust Territories of the Pacific Islands. Slaughtering, eviscerating, and processing of chickens; preparation; formulation; cooking; individually frozen and frozen (temperatures) shall be in accordance with Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS), Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381). Poultry which has been shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) FSIS or Poultry Products Grading Certificate, certifying grade (as applicable), class, condition, and slaughter date.

Unless otherwise specified, the chicken fillets or nuggets shall not have been processed and packaged prior to the date of the contract.

3.2 Types:

Type I - 3-ounce fillet. Each cooked, individually frozen, finished fillet shall weigh not less than 3 ounces. The fillets shall be packaged in plastic-film bags, with approximately 5 or 10 pounds of product per bag, and 8 or 4 bags packed in each shipping container, to a net weight of 40 pounds. The solicitation, contract, or purchase order shall indicate (a) finished product shape as round, oval, or no preference of shape, and (b) packaging in 5 or 10 pound bags, or packaged and packed in accordance with export or other requirements specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Type II - 5-ounce fillet. Each cooked, individually frozen, finished fillet shall weigh not less than 5 ounces. The fillets shall be packaged in plastic-film bags, with approximately 5 or 10 pounds of product per bag, and 8 or 4 bags packed in each shipping container, to a net weight of 40 pounds. The solicitation, contract, or purchase order shall indicate (a) finished product shape as round, oval, or no preference of shape, and (b) packaging in 5 or 10 pound bags, or packaged and packed in accordance with export or other requirements specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Type III - 0.5-ounce (1/2 ounce) nugget. Each cooked, individually frozen, finished nugget shall weigh not less than 0.5 ounce. The nuggets shall be packaged in plastic-film bags, with approximately 5 or 10 pounds of product per bag, and 8 or 4 bags packed in each shipping container, to a net weight of 40 pounds. The solicitation, contract, or purchase order shall indicate (a) finished product shape as round, oval, or no preference of shape, and (b) packaging in 5 or 10 pound bags, or packaged and packed in accordance with export or other requirements specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

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3.3 Styles:

Style A - Unbreaded fillets or nuggets. Each fillet or nugget shall be produced from chunked and formed, marinated (in accordance with 3.4.2.1) white chicken meat, which is formulated, cooked, and individually frozen in compliance with the requirements of this CID.

Style B - Breaded fillets or nuggets. Each fillet or nugget shall be produced from chunked and formed white chicken meat, which is formulated, batter/breaded, cooked, and individually frozen in compliance with the requirements of this CID.

3.4 Ingredients:

3.4.1 Ingredients for Style A and Style B (breaded and unbreaded products): The use of monosodium glutamate (MSG) is prohibited.

3.4.1.1 Chicken: Only breast meat with rib meat and other white chicken meat (first and second wing portion and scapula) in natural proportions shall be used to produce the products. The chickens from which the breast with rib meat and other white meat are derived shall be fresh chilled broiler/fryers. The chicken used may be offered as carcasses, bone-in parts, or boneless meat.

3.4.1.1.1 Unacceptable chicken meat: No mechanically deboned (comminuted) chicken meat, previously frozen chicken meat, or previously cooked chicken meat may be used in these products.

3.4.1.2 Sodium tripolyphosphate: Only Food Grade sodium tripolyphosphate shall be used.

3.4.1.3 Salt: Salt shall be iodized or noniodized, white refined sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.4.2 Ingredients for Style A (unbreaded products): The ingredients used to prepare the unbreaded chicken fillets and nuggets shall be chicken and marinade (water, salt, and sodium tripolyphosphate in the amounts specified in 3.4.2.1). No skin is permitted.

3.4.2.1 Marinating solution: For Style A products, the boneless, skinless chicken meat shall be marinated in a solution of water, salt, and sodium phosphates, before size reduction or forming. The amount and kind of restricted phosphates shall comply with 9 CFR Part 381. The marinating solution shall be formulated as follows:

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Water	88.75 percent
Salt	6.75 percent
Sodium tripolyphosphate	4.50 percent

The marinating solution must not increase the weight of the marinated meat by more than 10 percent over the original meat weight.

3.4.3 Ingredients for Style B (breaded products): The ingredients used to prepare the breaded chicken fillets and nuggets shall be chicken, sodium tripolyphosphate and salt, in the amounts described below; water (optional, in the amount specified in 3.4.3.3); and batter/breading ingredients. No skin is permitted.

3.4.3.1 Sodium tripolyphosphate: For Style B products, the sodium tripolyphosphate shall not exceed the levels permitted by the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381) of USDA.

3.4.3.2 Salt: For Style B products, not more than 0.25 percent salt (by weight of the total chicken meat) shall be used.

3.4.3.3 Water: For Style B products marination is not required, however, water may be used as a carrier for the phosphate and salt. When used, the water shall not constitute more than
2 percent of the total weight of the chicken meat. If water is used, the phosphate and salt must be mixed with the water and added as a solution to the meat during mixing/blending.

3.4.3.4 Batter/breading ingredients: Only commercially prepared batter/breading ingredients (not artificially colored) commonly used for the type of product specified shall be permitted.

3.5 Preparation and processing:

3.5.1 Preparation: All preparation and processing described below shall occur subsequent to the date of award. The product shall be processed, packaged and packed, and placed in a freezer within 7 calendar days after the day the chickens are slaughtered.

3.5.2 Preparation of chicken: If presented as carcasses or bone-in parts, the chicken shall be skinned and the bones removed.

The boned and trimmed chicken meat may be used as removed from the carcass or may be reduced in size by passing the chicken meat once through a kidney plate with openings of 2.50 inches in the least dimension. Fine grinding (less than dimensions shown), chopping (silent cutter, hydroflaker), or flake cutting of the chicken meat is not permitted.

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The boned and trimmed chicken meat shall be free of bone greater than 0.30 inch; and shall contain no (a) cartilage, ligaments, tendons, or coarse connective tissue greater than 0.50 inch in any dimension; (b) skin, bruises, or blood clots greater than 0.25 inch in any dimension; or (c) arteries, veins, or discolorations which exceed 1 inch.

3.5.3 Preparation of Style A (unbreaded products):

3.5.3.1 Marinating: The chicken meat shall be (a) used as removed from the carcass (as detailed in 3.5.2) and marinated in accordance with 3.4.2.1, or (b) marinated (in accordance with 3.4.2.1) and reduced in size as detailed in 3.5.2.

3.5.3.2 Forming: The marinated chicken meat shall be mechanically formed to comply with the product weight requirements. The thickness of the plate used to form the fillets or nuggets shall be approximately 3/8 inch.

3.5.3.3 Cooking: The product shall be cooked by any method or combination of methods allowed by the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. An internal product temperature of 160EF shall be obtained during cooking. No coconut, palm kernel, or other tropical oils shall be allowed in the cooking process. The deep fat fryer oil shall be continuously filtered and the equipment cleaned on a daily basis.

3.5.4 Preparation of Style B (breaded products): The chicken meat shall be (a) used as removed from the carcass, or (b) reduced in size as detailed in 3.5.2.

3.5.4.1 Mixing and forming: The chicken meat shall be mixed with salt, sodium tripolyphosphate, and water (water is optional) in accordance with the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The mixed product shall be mechanically formed to comply with the product weight requirements. The thickness of the plate used to form the fillets or nuggets shall be approximately 3/8 inch.

3.5.4.2 Batter/breading: The formed chicken fillets or nuggets shall be uniformly coated with batter and breading. All batter and breading shall be applied by machine. Combined batter and breading shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the uncooked breaded product weight.

3.5.4.3 Cooking: The product shall be cooked in accordance with 3.5.3.3.

3.5.5 Reprocessing:

3.5.5.1 Product eligible for reprocessing: Uncooked, unbattered, unbreaded, or unbatter/breaded chicken fillets or nuggets may be reprocessed.

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3.5.5.2 Product ineligible for reprocessing: Battered, breaded, batter/breaded, or cooked breaded chicken fillets or nuggets are ineligible for reprocessing.

3.5.6 Freezing:

1. The cooked product shall be chilled and individually frozen by a method in accordance with the FSIS requirements, so that individual fillets or nuggets do not stick together after freezing.

2. Immediately after individual freezing, the product shall be placed in a freezer held at 0EF or below. The internal product temperature shall be lowered to 0°F or lower within 72 hours from the time the product enters the freezer. The internal product temperature shall not exceed 0EF at the time of shipment and delivery.

3.5.7 Metal detection: All product will be examined by a metal detection device capable of detecting metals that may be present in the product. The metal detection device shall be accepted by FSIS, and the procedures used shall be appropriate for the depth of the detection field of the device and the sensitivity of the device.

The examination shall be by (a) presenting the product in its smallest dimension (thickness) within the detection field of the device, and (b) examining the product prior to packaging, or after packaging, or in a shipping container.

The contractor will test the metal detection device by methods applicable to the device, under the supervision of USDA. The frequency of testing will be according to the Poultry Division's online procedures.

These guidelines do not relieve the contractor of its responsibility to provide a safe product. Any product suspected of containing or found to contain metal will be handled according to and the disposition of the product determined by FSIS procedures.

3.5.8 Finished product requirements: The cooked product shall comply with the following requirements:

3.5.8.1 Cooked unbreaded and breaded products:

1. Fillets or nuggets shall contain no (a) foreign material (e.g., dirt, hair, grease, insect parts, metal); (b) foreign color(s); or (c) foreign odors or flavors (e.g., stale, sour, rancid, musty, moldy).

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2. Fillets or nuggets shall not be (a) fractured (separated into two or more separate pieces), (b) scorched or burned; or (c) soggy, excessively oily or greasy, or sticky.

3. The net weight of each cooked, fillet or nugget shall be as follows:

(a) Type I - Not less than 3.0 ounces,

(b) Type II - Not less than 5.0 ounces, or

(c) Type III - Not less than 0.5 ounce.

3.5.8.2 Cooked breaded products:

1. The combined batter and breading of each cooked breaded fillet or nugget shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the uncooked breaded fillet or nugget weight.

2. Cooked breaded fillets and nuggets shall have a golden brown color within the tolerances of the current edition of the Poultry Division's color control guidelines.

3. The cooked, breaded fillets or nuggets shall not (a) have more than one area of missing or not completely cooked batter/breading; or (b) contain lumps (outcropping of breading on the surface of the fillet or nugget) or ridges (excess breading which projects at the surface of a fillet or nugget).

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

The chicken fillets or nuggets shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The delivered chicken fillets or nuggets shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, processing, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the chicken fillets and nuggets within the commercial marketplace. Delivered chicken fillets or nuggets shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The chicken fillets or nuggets shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer’s own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same chicken fillets or nuggets offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

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5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined by the Grading Branch, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, the determination shall be made in accordance with applicable Poultry Division procedures. The chicken fillets or nuggets shall be examined or tested for compliance to the product requirements in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

6.2 Packaging and packing. Packaging and packing shall be in accordance with current commercial practices that are commercially acceptable for consumer-type packaging and packing.

6.3 Marking and labeling. Shipping containers shall be marked and labeled as prescribed in the applicable contract or solicitation document(s). The marking and labeling of the product shall be in accordance with the requirements of 9 CFR Part 381. The labels shall be approved by the Facilities, Equipment, Labeling and Compound Review Division, FSIS, USDA, prior to use [9 CFR § 381.134].

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Types(s).
- Style(s).
- Product shape (Indicate round, oval, or no preference).
- Packaging and packing (Indicate commercial, export, and whether packaged 5 or 10 pounds of product per plastic-film bag (as applicable)).
- Labeling, packaging, and other requirements if different from normal commercial requirements practice.

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7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

7.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 7 CFR Parts 53 to 209 and 9 CFR Parts 200 to end. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DLA - SS

(Project No. 8905-P014)

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